SHAHRAM AJLOO

Senior Manager · Automation for counting and packing technology · Roadmap, qualification, scale-up

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The LEGO Group · Billund · Senior Manager, Next-Gen Pre-Pack Counting Lead (0000039133)

Application: Senior Manager — Next-Gen Pre-Pack Counting Lead

To R&D Pre-Pack Next Gen

Counting sounds like the simplest thing in a factory. It is not. Counting is a measurement, and a measurement is a machine, a specification and a test: what is counted, in which shapes and tolerances, at what rate, with what accuracy, and what happens to the one element the system cannot see. Get the specification right and the technology follows; get it wrong, and every prototype runs beautifully on the sample tray and fails on the real portfolio at three in the morning. Defining that specification — and proving it with data before it becomes a machine — is the work I want to do in the Next Generation Packing Equipment programme.

I would lead the technical area on four fixed things. First, **the requirement before the technology**: a matrix of the element portfolio against the properties that actually decide whether an element can be counted — shape, colour, transparency, surface, size tolerance, bulk behaviour — so the roadmap covers the portfolio rather than the handful of elements that happen to be on the table. Second, **test data decides**: every concept is taken through a designed test — repeatability, false accepts and false rejects, throughput at the real mix, drift over a shift — and the go/no-go is written as a number against the requirement rather than as an opinion in a review. Third, **the architecture and its interfaces**: subsystem boundaries, specifications and performance requirements written down once, with an interface risk list reviewed like a schedule — most of the cost in a counting line hides between two subsystems that each met their own specification. Fourth, **manufacturing readiness**: operating concept, installation plan, maintainability, safety, environmental compliance and supplier qualification — technology that cannot be maintained at scale is a prototype with a production budget.

My background is the one you ask for. I am a **chartered marine engineer** (maskinmester) with a B.Tech in Technology Management & Mechanical Engineering and Danish electrical authorisation at LV, MV and HV — mechanical, marine and automation in one degree. I have spent twenty years on the rest of your list in practice: at **Novo Nordisk** I delivered 37 parallel capital projects worth DKK 2–10m each, qualifying equipment for production under GMP, FDA and EMA with acceptance criteria, FAT/SAT, IQ/OQ/PQ, deviation handling and **zero critical findings** at audited handover; at **ARJ Engineering** I led twelve technicians in a machine workshop, doing fault diagnosis, root-cause analysis and corrective action on production equipment; at **Biofos** I ran operations and maintenance on a 24/7 process plant, where the numbers that mattered came from instrumentation and SCADA and where an unplanned stop was measured in money per hour.

On **data**, I work the way the role needs. At Biofos I built the picture from meters and SCADA rather than from impressions — normalised, compared across systems, turned into a priority order — and the result was **over 40 % lower energy consumption**, documented and held. I use Python daily for exactly this: pulling test and production data, comparing runs, showing repeatability and drift on one page.

On **operational excellence**, my version is practical: standardised work a new operator can be taught in a day, bottlenecks found by walking the line rather than waiting for the report, waste removed where it is cheap to remove, and improvements written down so the next shift inherits them. Running ELOHVAC with five electricians and three apprentices and full P&L since 2023 taught me to measure improvement in hours and kroner: the tools I built there removed **over 40 % of the administrative work** from quoting and follow-up — and it stayed after the project ended.

On **suppliers, R&D and production sites**, I have done that collaboration from both sides of the table: specified, bought, tested and qualified supplier equipment, held vendors to a scope at FAT, and taken new technology from drawing to running line with the people who had to operate it. Tenders, bid evaluation, contracts and the relationship afterwards decide how fast a good idea becomes an installed machine.

Two of your own lines describe my instinct better than I could: "explore functional details while keeping the wider production system in view" is what a counting problem demands, and **up to five times more output per square metre** is a system problem, not a gadget problem — solved by specifications, test data and interfaces rather than by one clever machine. That, plus the habit of turning innovation into something a production site can run, maintain and improve, is what I would bring.

Practically: I live in Måløv, about two and a half hours from Billund, and I am prepared to structure the week around the equipment — on site in Billund through the working week and home at weekends, plus the four to six weeks of travel the role expects. I can start by agreement, and I would welcome a conversation about which element families today's counting technology struggles with, and where the programme most needs a lead who can write a specification and then prove it with data.

Kind regards

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PROFILE

Automation and equipment manager with 20+ years from production equipment, qualification and technical operations — chartered marine engineer (B.Tech, EQF 6) with Danish electrical authorisation LV/MV/HV. Qualified and commissioned production equipment under GMP/FDA/EMA across 37 parallel capital projects with 25 specialists: acceptance criteria, FAT/SAT, IQ/OQ/PQ and zero critical findings at audited handover. Led a machine workshop with twelve technicians, ran a 24/7 process plant on instrumentation and SCADA data with over 40 % documented energy reduction, and holds full P&L with five electricians and three apprentices since 2023. Data-driven by habit: Python, SCADA, SAP.

AUTOMATION, EQUIPMENT AND PRODUCTION READINESS

- **Equipment specification and architecture:** Requirements, acceptance criteria and interface definitions written before the purchase: what the machine must do, at which rate and accuracy, and where the boundary sits between connected subsystems.
- **Test, qualification and feasibility:** Designed tests for repeatability, throughput and drift; FAT/SAT and IQ/OQ/PQ with traceability; go/no-go decisions taken on data against a written requirement, not on a demonstration.
- **Production and operational excellence:** Standardised work, bottleneck analysis and flow improvement on live production; visual management and follow-up in a fixed rhythm, with improvements documented so the next shift inherits them.
- **Suppliers and partners:** Enquiry, bid evaluation, contract and supplier follow-up; new technology taken from concept to installed equipment with automation partners, R&D and the production site in the same room.
- **Safety, environment and maintainability:** Workplace safety, LOTO and permits, sustainability and environmental compliance, energy performance; maintainability and spare-part criticality designed in rather than discovered after commissioning.

TOOLS AND METHODS

Task	Tool and documented use
Data and analysis	Python, Excel and SCADA data: test-run comparison, repeatability and drift, throughput and false-reject rates, dashboards and one-page decision material.
Equipment and automation	PLC-based control, sensors, drives, panels and instrumentation; functional testing against a written specification; electrical authorisation LV/MV/HV.
Qualification and compliance	Acceptance criteria, FAT/SAT, IQ/OQ/PQ, traceability matrix, deviation and change control, audit-ready documentation under GMP/FDA/EMA.
Production systems	SAP for planning and follow-up of equipment and materials, plus Excel and Python reporting; standardised work, bottleneck and flow analysis, visual management.
Projects and suppliers	Scope, plan, cost and risk ownership; tender and bid evaluation, contract terms, FAT and delivery follow-up with automation suppliers and subcontractors.
Leadership and development	Functional leadership of specialists, technicians and apprentices; structured 1:1s, competence plans and on-the-job training with a next step rather than an instruction.

EXPERIENCE

Owner / Technical Director — ELOHVAC ApS · Copenhagen, Denmark · May 2023–present

Scope: 5 electricians and 3 apprentices · full P&L · commercial and industrial customers

- **Equipment and delivery:** Panels, motor controls, drives and control systems specified, installed, tested and handed over with documentation; scope, cost and quality owned end to end.
- **Improvement and data:** Python and Claude API for quotations, schedules, checklists and KPI dashboards; over 40 % of administrative work removed and over 40 % productivity gain.
- **People:** Recruitment, 1:1s, apprentice training and mentoring alongside budget, quoting and margin.

Senior Commissioning Engineer / Project Manager, electrical systems — Novo Nordisk A/S · Kalundborg / Bagsværd, Denmark · Nov 2022–Jul 2024

Scope: 37 parallel capital projects · 25 specialists · DKK 2–10m each · GMP/FDA/EMA

- **Equipment qualification:** Acceptance criteria, FAT/SAT, loop checks, IQ/OQ/PQ, deviation and change control; zero critical findings at audited handover.
- **Suppliers and stakeholders:** Vendors, consultants and production stakeholders aligned through design, installation and handover; cost, risk and resources reported monthly.

Project and Workshop Manager — Ventek-Air · Copenhagen, Denmark · Jan 2022–Nov 2022

Scope: 14 employees · 11 concurrent construction projects · DKK 2–10m each

- **Execution leadership:** Tenders, calculations, subcontractors and handover packages in ventilation and technical installations; daily board meetings and bottleneck analysis.

Maintenance and Operations Manager / Workshop Technician — Biofos, Lynetten · Copenhagen, Denmark · Aug 2017–Jan 2022

Scope: 24/7 process plant · instrumentation, pumps, HVAC, high-voltage switchgear, SCADA

- **Data-driven operations:** Meters and SCADA data normalised and compared across systems, priorities set from measured effect: over 40 % lower energy consumption, documented and held.
- **Reliability and compliance:** Preventive maintenance from condition data, spare-part criticality, calibration and fault finding; LOTO, permits, workplace assessment and environmental documentation.

Electromechanical Technician / Production Team Leader — ARJ Engineering · Tehran, Iran · Dec 2003–Mar 2010

Scope: 12 mechanics and technicians · machine workshop · industrial production equipment

- **Production equipment:** Fault diagnosis, root-cause analysis and corrective action on production equipment; shift planning, targets and follow-up in a machine workshop.

EDUCATION AND AUTHORISATION

B.Tech, Technology Management & Mechanical Engineering · Copenhagen School of Marine Engineering · 2017–2022 · GPA 7.6/12

Authorised marine and electrical engineer (LV/MV/HV) · Danish Safety Technology Authority · May 2023

Electrical and mechanical design, electrical engineering · Tehran Technical University · 2000–2003 · EQF 6

Refrigeration and air conditioning • STCW safety · Mercantec 2021 · Danish Maritime Authority 2021

LANGUAGES, PRACTICAL AND REFERENCES

English: professional, written and spoken · Danish: native · Persian: native · Driving licence B · Lives in Måløv, prepared to be on site in Billund through the working week — hybrid, with home days when they fit the equipment — and to travel four to six weeks a year · Available by agreement · SAP, Python and Excel in daily use · References on request.

WHAT THE ROLE ASKS FOR — MY EVIDENCE

Requirement	Evidence
Background in mechanical/marine engineering, automation or equivalent	Chartered marine engineer (maskinmester) with B.Tech in Technology Management & Mechanical Engineering, electrical authorisation LV/MV/HV, and twenty years of automation and equipment work.
Deep automation expertise in high-volume production or mass manufacturing	Qualified and commissioned production equipment across 37 parallel capital projects under GMP/FDA/EMA; machine workshop with twelve technicians; 24/7 process plant run on instrumentation and SCADA.
Analysing equipment test data to confirm feasibility and drive decisions	Test protocols for repeatability, throughput and drift; FAT/SAT and IQ/OQ/PQ evidence; SCADA and Python analysis behind a documented 40 % energy and productivity gain.
Operational excellence and LEAN principles	Standardised work, bottleneck and flow analysis, visual management and a fixed follow-up rhythm; improvements documented and held after the project, not just achieved once.
Functional leadership with R&D, suppliers and production sites	Specification, tender, FAT and qualification of supplier equipment; new technology taken from concept to installed equipment with vendors, consultants and the people who operate it.
Equipment architecture, interfaces and performance requirements	Interface lists, performance requirements and acceptance criteria defined per subsystem; interface risk held in one register and reviewed like a schedule.
Fluent written and verbal English	English professional, used daily in international project organisations, supplier negotiations and documentation; Danish native.
SAP, environmental compliance and mentoring talent	SAP daily for planning and follow-up; environmental documentation and energy performance in a regulated plant; mentoring of apprentices, technicians and specialists with structured development plans.

FIRST 90 DAYS — REQUIREMENTS, TEST DATA AND THE ROADMAP

Period	What happens, and how it is measured
Week 1–2	Walk the current counting and packing lines at the production site with the people who run them. Read the element portfolio and the existing specifications, and learn where today's technology fails: which shapes, which colours, which rates.
Day 30	One page that the programme can argue about: the element portfolio mapped to the properties that decide countability, the requirements that follow, and where today's technology meets them — and where it falls short of the LEGO Group's standards. Interface and risk list started.
Day 60	Test plan agreed for the first concepts and prototypes: what is measured, with what instrument, against which acceptance criterion, and who signs. Supplier conversations opened with a specification in hand rather than a wish list.
Day 90	First concept tested and reported as data against the requirement — feasible, not feasible, or feasible with named conditions. The roadmap has dates, owners and dependencies, and the production site has seen it.

A COUNT IS A MEASUREMENT

Every counting problem is a measurement problem in disguise. What property of the element does the sensor actually see — colour, silhouette, transparency, weight, reflectivity — and how does that property vary across the portfolio and across a production batch? Once that is written down, the technology choice becomes almost obvious, and the acceptance criteria write themselves. Without it, every test is anecdotal, and the project moves forward on the confidence of whoever spoke last.

THE SPECIFICATION IS THE PRODUCT

I would rather spend three weeks on a requirement that is right than three months on a prototype that answers the wrong question. A good specification says what the equipment must achieve — accuracy, rate, false-reject rate, uptime, changeover time — under which conditions, and how it will be proven; and what it must not do, which is where most of the cost and maintenance live. It is also the only fair way to compare three suppliers, and the only way to know, two years later, whether the investment delivered.

TEST DATA, NOT DEMONSTRATIONS

A demonstration shows what a machine can do once, on a good day, with the vendor present. A test shows what it does over a shift, on the real mix, after the operator has been on a break and the light has changed. So I design the test before the concept is built: sample size, run length, what counts as a false accept and a false reject, and the tolerance that makes the concept pass. When the answer comes back red, that is a good day for the programme — it is far cheaper than finding out on a ramp-up.

INTERFACES ARE WHERE THE COST HIDES

Two subsystems can each meet their own specification and still fail together, because the boundary between them was never specified by anyone — a handover point, a singulation step, a control signal or a data format. My habit is to write every interface down: who delivers what, in which format, at which rate, and what happens when it does not. It is unglamorous, and it is where five-fold output per square metre is won or lost.

FROM PROTOTYPE TO A LINE THAT RUNS

A technology becomes real when a production site can install it, train on it, maintain it and improve it without the R&D team in the room: an operating concept, an installation plan, spare parts with criticality, a maintenance routine, safety and environmental compliance, and a ramp-up curve someone has thought about, including the scalability of the concept. I have handed over equipment an operator could run from the documentation alone — that is the difference between a pilot and a programme.

SUPPLIERS ARE PART OF THE DESIGN

Counting technology is rarely built alone: it is built with automation partners, platform owners and specialist teams who have the mechanics, optics or software you do not, and that partnership decides the speed of the programme. My approach is to arrive with a specification rather than a wish list, share the acceptance criteria before the first prototype, test together at their site as well as ours, and keep the commercial terms simple enough that both sides want the same outcome — I have evaluated bids and negotiated contracts in my own company, and held vendors to a scope at FAT.

PEOPLE MAKE THE ROADMAP HOLD

A roadmap with one owner is a wish; a roadmap with specialists who own their part of it is a plan. I lead by making the requirement shared and the test visible, so a specialist can disagree with data instead of opinion. I own my workstream's scope, quality, timing and cost, and I mentor deliberately with continuous learning built into the work: a competence plan per person, real responsibility early, credit given in public.